

Swaddling: If your newborn cries a lot, is fussy, or has trouble sleeping, try swaddling them.

Being wrapped tightly in blankets, with the arms bound, makes babies feel the way they did when they were in the uterus, and it calms them. In fact, some babies sleep an extra hour or two when swaddled and may even need to be unswaddled to wake up for their feedings. Be sure that any blankets you use for swaddling are tightly wrapped around the baby, because loose blankets can cover a baby's face and so become a factor for Sudden Infant Death Syndrome (SIDS). You may have learned how to swaddle your baby in the hospital. If not, your pediatrician should know how to do it. There are also simple swaddling products on the market that use Velcro tabs for a snug fit, thus eliminating the need to learn how to properly swaddle. These products can be found online or in stores.